

3.6 Advice for examiners during Task A discussion and Tasks B and C conversations

- Do not point at anything (people, objects or interactions) in the picture for Task A.
- Avoid yes/no questions, except as a lead-in to something more challenging.
- Ensure that questions allow candidates to achieve their maximum potential, for example by covering a range of tenses/time references and opinions as appropriate within the prescribed time for the conversation.
- Throughout the conversation, in order to facilitate a genuine and spontaneous interaction, the nature of questions from the teacher/examiner should enable candidates to:
(1) answer questions freely, in turn allowing them to produce extended sequences of speech, (2) develop conversations and discussions, (3) give and justify own thoughts and opinions, (4) refer to past, present and future events.
- Never correct a candidate's language, however inaccurate, during a test.
- Avoid finishing sentences for candidates, except where it would be in their interest to move on to something else.
- Try to stimulate candidates to produce their best performance, taking them to their 'linguistic ceiling' but being careful not to press on with questions of a certain difficulty if it becomes clear that a candidate cannot cope at that level.
- Interventions (questions, brief statements, instructions, comments, etc.) should always flexibly develop and logically build on what candidates have said.
- Candidates should be encouraged to speak independently and spontaneously and must not be allowed to produce rehearsed speeches – candidates who repeat pre-learned or memorised material should be encouraged to produce more spontaneous discourse.

Grammar list

Students are expected to have acquired knowledge and understanding of French grammar during their course. In the examination they will be required to apply their knowledge and understanding to various tasks, drawing from the following lists.

The examples in brackets are indicative, not exclusive.

For structures marked **(R)**, only receptive knowledge is required.

Nouns

gender

singular and plural forms

Articles

definite, indefinite and partitive, including use of *de* after negatives

Adjectives

agreement

comparative and superlative: regular, including *meilleur, pire*

demonstrative (*ce, cet, cette, ces*)

indefinite (e.g. *chaque, quelque*)

possessive

interrogative (e.g. *quel, quelle, quels, quelles*)

Adverbs

comparative and superlative: regular, including *mieux, le mieux*

interrogative (e.g. *comment, quand*)

adverbs of time and place (e.g. *aujourd'hui, demain, ici, là-bas*)

common adverbial phrases

Quantifiers/intensifiers

e.g. *très, assez, beaucoup, peu, trop*

Pronouns

personal: all subjects, including *on*

reflexive

object: direct and indirect use of *y, en*

position and order of object pronouns

disjunctive/emphatic

demonstrative (e.g. *ça, cela, celui*)

possessive (e.g. *le mien*)

relative: *qui, que, où, lequel, auquel, duquel, dont* **(R)**

indefinite (e.g. *quelqu'un*)

interrogative (e.g. *qui, que*)

Verbs

regular and irregular forms of verbs,
including reflexive verbs

all persons of verbs, singular and plural

negative forms

interrogative forms

modes of address: *tu, vous*

impersonal verbs (e.g. *il faut*)

verbs followed by an infinitive, with or
without a preposition

dependent infinitives (*faire réparer*) **(R)**

tenses:

- present
- perfect
- imperfect
- immediate/near future
- simple future
- conditional
- pluperfect use of *depuis* with present and
imperfect tenses

passive voice **(R)**

imperative

perfect infinitive

present participle, including use after *en*

subjunctive mood: present, in commonly
used expressions **(R)**

Conjunctions

co-ordinating (e.g. *car, donc, ensuite*) and
subordinating (e.g. *lorsque, puisque, comme*)

Numbers, quantity, dates and time

including use of *depuis* with present and
imperfect tenses